



Carrigtwohill & District Historical Society

Christmas Newsletter 2024

Committee Business

Chairman's Address

By Jim Barry

Christmas 2024 is here already, unfortunately I suffered health issues during the year and missed out on a lot of the Society's activities. Thanks to our committee members who kept the Society business going.

With Covid a thing of the past, the year started off with a few well attended lectures one being, Making Hay the Old Way by the Rev. Mons. Reidy which brought back many old memories, and no doubt the Mons. knows a thing or two about making hay.

It had been decided to publish a Parish Book on the History, Heritage, and Folklore of Carrigtwohill, all our neighboring Parishes have books and we can't leave Carrigtwohill lag behind, this of course is a task that's easier said than done, there is an old saying sure we can leave that now till after Christmas, or that will be grand till after Christmas, or we will make a fresh start in the New Year, what ever about the sayings, we intend having the book for sale for Christmas 2025

Other projects in hand include the depositing of the Daibhi de Barra manuscript in the City and County Archives for safe keeping, an article written by Tony O Floinn a member of our committee called to Virginia and Back Again, the story of how a short Daibhi de Barra manuscript made its way from Carrigtwohill to the US. And was brought back again by Paul Doherty in 2019, has been published in the 2024 J.C.H.A.S Journal

The Society is also busy pursuing efforts to encourage the County Council Heritage Department to provide funds to safeguard and preserve the Abbey tower at St Davids Church, during the year an on-site meeting was held with officials of the County Council Heritage Department

I would like to take this opportunity to thank Ollie Sheehan and his wife Mary, of Mary Geary Child Care, for providing their premises to the Society for meetings and lectures, and indeed our members and friends for their support, to all a very Happy Christmas and a prosperous New Year, and we look forward to seeing you all again in 2025

Phone 087 2533768, or email jimei8gs@gmail.com

Society Business

By André Saubolle (Secretary)

In January the society received €2602.50 from the Eirgrid Local Community Funding being 50% of the amount awarded us. This we earmarked for the publication of our book of the parish history which is now at an advanced stage. This money remained in our Credit Union account until recently when it was paid to our appointed publisher, Carrig

Print, this being a condition to claim the remaining 50% by the end of December.

As Jim has just outlined, the year got off to an excellent start with two very well attended fabulous presentations. This was followed by a period when we were unable to appoint any specialist guest speakers until August when we welcomed Matt Barry of the Pennsylvania Barry DNA Project for his presentation at Fota House sponsored by their management. That event attracted in excess of two hundred guests.

In March was the official launch of the C2H2040 consultation document to which many of our members have contributed articles, took place at the GAA new clubhouse at their invitation.

At a committee meeting held in May votes were undertaken which resulted in our society adopting two resolutions in relation the Augustinian Canon Abbey Site. The first to 'Work at ways to preserve the site', and that 'We to make grant applications for 2025.' Our stated objective that day was to discuss all Government and County Council grant funding options that are available that our society may avail of. An invitation was made to the County Council, which was accepted with an onsite meeting arranged for June, attended by our committee members, and members of the County Council Heritage Department.

Other than the occasional general email circular, May was the only newsletter issued this year which has been commented on by a few of our members. Although much has been happening in the background, since May there has been very little to report.

The year 2025 will mark the 840th anniversary of the arrival of Philip de Barri of Manorbier, Pembrokeshire, Wales, into Ireland, and is the subject of an article in the Federation of Local Historical Societies. It will also be the year when The Poor Servants of the Mother of God will celebrate the 150th anniversary of their arrival in the village, and when Carrigtwohill & District Historical Society intend to publish their book of the parish history.

At our last committee meeting of the year it was agreed we shall seek the rebooking of Brendan Goggin and Derry Keogh. Both their presentations were well received, and both gents agreed to make return visits. We are also liaising with Tom O'Neill who has offered a presentation about Spike Island. Another is proposed which is to be given by Tomás Ó Murchú whose specialist subject is the Irish writings on the death of Young James Cotter.



Book of the Parish History



In our May issue, and as mentioned by Jim's introduction you would have read about the book of the parish history the society is in the process of drafting.

The collation of articles is now at an advanced stage which consists of a number of diverse and interesting subjects, contributed by authors of equally varied backgrounds. Many are still being formulated by the authors which it is hoped should be with us early in the New Year.

In that issue we invited anyone who wished to contribute their story to for consideration to forward us a copy. This invitation attracted a limited response with a deadline for October. If there are still those considering offering an article, please feel free to do so as soon as possible.

As a reminder we outline proposed basic Table of Contents as a guide only. It does not matter if your story does not precisely fit the headings, as we can work around it.

1. Early History of Carrigtwohill
2. The Coming of the Normans and the Middle Ages
3. Before and After the Battle of Kinsale
4. Before the Famine
5. After the Famine
6. Life Before and During World War 1
7. War of Independence and Civil War
8. Life in the Free State up to World War2
9. End of 20th Century
10. Into the 21st Century
11. General Items of Interest

Our committee is a small one with many projects in hand. This is another example for which we are now actively seeking an editor or editors from the membership to perform this vital service to be totally independent of the society's committee.



An aerial view of Barryscourt courtesy of Fred Adams, and one not previously seen. (November 2024)

Membership 2025

With Christmas yet around the corner, these last few days of the year are always expensive times. Unfortunately, December is also the month when annual membership ends, becoming due for renewal within a week of the Christmas festivities on the 1st January every year.

Your Historical Society can only function through its membership continued support, so we ask that you find the time to renew your membership at your earliest convenience. The renewal fee remains unchanged at €20, and may be given to any committee member, or paid by clicking the below 'Join or Renew your Membership' button.

Join or Renew
your Membership



As a committee we are always looking volunteers from the membership to undertake specific projects from time to time. We are currently keen to hear from anyone who would like to form a sub-committee to help manage the Abbey Project announced in our last circular in accordance with our 'Proposal to Preserve St David's Abbey Site' document as an attachment.



Recent & Up Coming Events

Poor Servants of the Mother of God 150 years of Presence in Carrigtwohill 1875 – 2025

By Sister Mary Kenefick (SMG)



It is with real joy that we share with you the good news of our 150th Celebrations among the people of Carrigtwohill. Mother Magdalen Taylor, following the invitation from Dora Fitzgerald and Fr Seymour to open a community here, arrived by train with two other Sisters on 21st June 1875.

Many Sisters have come to minister here over the years and many of the people have shared their joys and sorrows with them. We all have much to thank God for going back over the generations.

This coming year we are showcasing some events to mark this glorious occasion. The St Patrick's Day Parade will feature a float in the parade led by Scoil Chlochair Mhuire. The pupils from this school will also perform a drama later in the year to relate the story of Mother Magdalen.

Our Bishop of Cloyne, Most Rev William Crean, D.D., will concelebrate Holy Mass at St Mary's Church, Carrigtwohill on 15th May 2025. The liturgy will be led by the staff and pupils of St Aloysius College, Carrigtwohill.

As Eleven Sisters from this parish entered Our Congregation, the Poor Servants of the Mother of God, you will hear at some point in the year, that eleven trees will be planted in their memory.

	Birth Name	Name in Religion	Born	Death
1	Nora Barry	Sr M. Ita	08.09.1883	27.10.1957
2	Ann O'Neill	Sr M. Gonzaga	13.02.1890	21.12.1974
3	Margaret Barry	Sr M. St. David	21.11.1893	08.11.1980
4	Gertrude Fitzgerald	Sister M. Leonard	25.08.1904	01.04.1989
5	Eileen McCarthy	Sister M. Bertrand	21.10.1911	27.10.1993
6	Mary Barry	Sr Anne Aloysius	01.10.1918	01.02.1979
7	Hannah Canty	Sr Rose Gregory	08.12.1920	11.11.1994
8	Margaret Canty	Sr Margaret Canty	01.01.1925	04.12.1973
9	Margaret Fenton	Sr Rose Conception	03.07.1925	15.07.2016
10	Kathleen O'Neill	Sr M. Canisius	18.11.1933	01.01.2015
11	Bridget (Beryl) Meehan	Sr Raphael	08.04.1935	09/07/1998

On the 21st June 2025, there will be an enactment of the arrival of the Sisters. Three ladies accompanied by local people will walk the walk from the Railway Station to the Church, pray some prayers, sing some hymns and then proceed to the Community Centre to open an Exhibition of photographs, stories, artefacts from our various ministries around the world and genealogies of the eleven Carrigtwohill families whose daughters joined us.

POOR SERVANTS OF THE MOTHER OF GOD
ORDER OF RELIGIOUS SISTERS

First arrived in Carrigtwohill, Co. Cork.
21st June 1875

In 2025 we celebrate 150 years serving the
Carrigtwohill Community

SMG 150

EXIBITION

21ST and 22ND JUNE 2025
1.00pm to 6.00pm each day
Carrigtwohill Community Centre

Our exhibition will illustrate
the Religious, Historical, Cultural, Social and
Economic impact the SMG Sisters
have in the Community of Carrigtwohill.



Mother Magdalen Taylor
SMG Foundress



Fr. Richard Seymour
Carrigtwohill P.P. in 1875




Produced by John FitzGerald originally intended to be displayed at the City Hall Exhibition.

The year of celebration will be brought to a close on 24th September 2025 with an engaging talk from Paul Shaw, SMG Congregational Archivist. Paul will recount Mother Magdalen's visit to Ireland visiting all the Religious Orders in this country from her book *Irish Homes and Irish Hearts, 1867*. Mother said of the Irish people: "first taught me the worth of Irish Character, the warmth of Irish Hearts, and the depth of Irish Faith."

Check it out [here](#)

We look forward to meeting you at some or all of these events as the year unfolds.

We send you warm wishes for a blessed Christmas and a happy New Year.



Hidden Myths and Forgotten People

By Marie J McCarthy

A public display of local historical posters from various individuals from local history societies, countrywide was held at Bishopstown library in 2024. This was a combined effort of both The Federation of Local History Societies, and the Ulster Society of Local Studies.

Carrigtwohill and District Historical Society is a member of the former.

It was the first time this display was shown in Cork. This initiative which attempts to portray forgotten or hidden history facts about people and places was formerly opened at The National Library Dublin in 2018, by President M Higgins.

Cork was poorly represented, regrettably as very few posters have been produced in Cork city or county to date. So any of you who would like to produce a simple poster, literally by writing a paragraph and include a photograph about a person or place that you know well. To put Cork local history further on the map forward your poster article to Larry Breen, PRO, The Federation of Local History Societies, 8 The Paddocks, Naas, Co Kildare or e mail it to him: larrybreen8@outlook.com.



Marie J McCarthy presents Lord Mayor, Cllr Kieran McCarthy with a copy of the same poster presented to Michael Higgins. Read the full in this year's Federation Journal.

Celebrating Cork Past Exhibition, at City Hall

The passing of two Corkonians

By Marie J McCarthy

We lost two Corkonians of note this year of 2024. Both of these gentlemen were very enthusiastic local historians. who have gone to their eternal rest, within weeks of each other.

Brian Bermingham of Model Farm Road died in Spain while on a family holiday. He was a former Lord Mayor of Cork City, a Fine Gael Politician, served on Cork County Council and was an educator. I knew him personally as a wonderful historian who was one of the founding members of the Cork Celebrating the Past exhibition. This became an annual event held at City Hall Cork. It became a platform for the exhibition of local history societies work and it fostered good relationships between individual societies and was an educational resource for schools and teachers. Brian was a

very jovial and affable person, a proud Cork man who has left a legacy of history behind him and a good friend.

A few weeks later Richard T Cooke died unexpectedly, he was a colleague of Brian's. Richard was a founding member of *The Spirit of Mother Jones* festival in 2011 in Cork which became a yearly event held in the city. He was also a prolific author, a singer and initiated many heritage events and festivals. He also attended and helped at the City Hall celebrating Cork Past events.

I am glad to have known both of these great gentleman. We will miss them Ar dheis Dé go raibh a n'ainmeacha.

Barry DNA Project



The single most important event of the year was when our society welcomed Matt Barry amongst us at a venue kindly provided us by the management of Forta House for his presentation on a windswept summer's eve. This story was covered in our May issue.

Since then, there had been a development, as it was the intention whereby the society would once again host the Barry DNA Project. This time at the annual *Celebrating Cork Past Exhibition*, at City Hall. Permission was sought and granted from the organising committee to permit us an adjoining stall to promote the Barry DNA project, as they had kindly done for Paul Shaw the previous year.

In preparation for the exhibition, and while Matt was still in our company, we were presented with the following excellent poster designed by the daughter Edd Barry of Fermoy, a co-administrator of the project who sought her assistance to produce it. It was to be as a prominent display at the exhibition, in the hope of attracting the interest of potential DNA doners.

Soon after Matt's return home to Pennsylvania he kindly purchased DNA gift cards specifically for anyone who wished to take part in the project that we were intending to distribute at the exhibition. There are a limited number left valued at \$50 and \$100, with only one DNA kit. If any male Barry would like to avail of this offer, please do drop use a note outlining your interest.

Matt, in recent correspondence confirms that of the four kits initially supplied, two have proved positive as being Barrymore descendants within their group tagged as "Barry Roe". A third has been stuck in the system since July. The final kit has not yet been received at the laboratory.

Of the second batch, we believed one of these kits been posted, but Matt advises that there is no record yet of it being received. The second has not yet been issued.

Matt further mentions that "a random man Steven Barry from Syracuse, New York, joined the project recently he's also in the 'Barrymore' Y11179 group but not in the 'Barryroe' Y13610 group. He believes his ancestors were from Drimoleague. His closest matches are the two men named Mitchell living in Cornwall."

Matt will keep us updated as and when results are known.



The Barry Surname Project

The Irish Barry family is commonly considered to be of Cambro-Norman origin, having arrived in Ireland with the 12th century Norman-Welsh invasion, although recent scholarship indicates that the family probably originated in the Ecclesiastic Principality of Tournai.

In Ireland the family is associated primarily with County Cork where several branches developed:

BARRY MOR (Great or Elder Barry)
BARRY ROE (Red Barry) and
BARRY OG (Younger Barry)

Other branches of the family had variations on their names such as:

BARRY BHÁN/BARRIVANE (White Barry) and **BARRY LAIDIR** (Strong Barry)

There were also compound names including the **MACROBINSON/MACROBSTON BARRYS**, the **MAC JAMES (FITZJAMES BARRYS)**, the **MACADAM BARRYS** and the **SMITH BARRYS**.

In later centuries this Barry family dispersed throughout Ireland and its members can be found today in every county, as well as in North America, England, Australia, New Zealand, France and in every location of the Irish Diaspora.

Some Barrys are native Irish, rather than Cambro-Norman or Tournaisien in origin, having descended from the **O'BAIRE CLAN of West Cork**, or **O'BEARE** or **O'BEARGHA** families of Mayo and Limerick, respectively. The variant Barrie may be of Scottish origin. In addition, some Barry families changed their name to Barry for various reasons. If this was the case in your family, please consider joining both this project and the Barry surname project.

Could you be one of us?

One of the major goals of this project is to sort out the various branches of the Barry family and confirm or refine the information on these diverse groups and their origins.

Eligibility

The Barry project is open to all women and men who have direct Barry ancestors on any line of descent. See list of surnames for all eligible name variations.

YDNA Testing Recommendations

Men who are, or suspect they may be, direct paternal Barry descendants should begin with YDNA testing. We recommend a YDNA test of at least 37 markers. If you have already tested with another company, you may be able to transfer and supplement your results at a low cost.

We also suggest that you do additional YDNA testing to determine your haplogroup, or deep paternal ancestral group. The project administrators can advise you on testing options.

Autosomal Testing Recommendations

Women, and men whose Barry ancestors are on other than direct paternal lines, should begin with an autosomal DNA test, which evaluates all direct ancestral branches. (This is also valuable for men who are direct Barry paternal descendants.) Autosomal testing is available through FamilyTreeDNA's FamilyFinder test. Individuals who tested with other companies may be able to transfer their results to Family Finder for a fee.



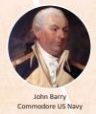




Mick Barry
Champion Road Bowler



James Barry
4th Earl of Barrymore



John Barry
Commodore US Navy



Tom Barry
IRA Commander



Visit The Barry Surname Project for more information.
 Scan the QR code or visit:
www.familytreedna.com/groups/barry/about

PSMG 150th Anniversary

Also intended to be displayed at the City Hall exhibition was a poster outlining the local community's commemorations

celebrating the 150th anniversary of the Poor Servants of the Mother of God arrival in the village. It is included later in this newsletter.

C2H2040 Updates of Projects the Society Supports

Schools' Folklore Project

By Angela Byrne

The Carrigtwohill Schools Folklore Project is a collaborative effort to preserve and celebrate our rich cultural heritage. The project is part of the Heritage and Culture Strand of Carrigtwohill's resident written C2H2040 plan, acknowledging the voice of youth in recording our shared heritage.

We are delighted to announce the winners of the 2024 Schools folklore collection. The project saw enthusiastic participation from 5th class students across all three primary schools in Carrigtwohill, with exceptional contributions from each class.

All of the participating schools followed a format inspired by the original 1930s Irish Folklore Schools Collection, using similar Topic lists to gather local stories and traditions. The winning class, 5th class students from Scoil Chlochair Mhuire, stood out with their beautifully decorated manuscript covers and the rich, diverse folklore they collected. Their work reflected the global influences within Carrigtwohill today, with stories and traditions gathered not only from Irish families but from communities all around the world.

As recognition for their superb efforts, the winning class will be treated to a special prize: a class trip to Fota Wildlife Park's new state-of-the-art education centre. The students will have the opportunity to learn about Ireland's native plants and animals, further deepening their appreciation of the natural world and its place in Irish heritage.

Sharing the Folklore with the Community

The folklore collected through this project is intended to be shared with the wider community. With the appropriate funding, the collection will be published in print, allowing families to enjoy these stories for generations to come. Additionally, a community event will be planned to celebrate

the new collection and revisit the 1930s folklore collection. This event will provide an opportunity to honour the cultural richness of Carrigtwohill, past and present.

The Carrigtwohill Schools Folklore Project, in partnership with the Carrigtwohill Community Council, extends its deepest thanks to Fota Wildlife Park for donating this wonderful prize and to High Street Books for donating the manuscripts that the children used to record the folklore. We would also like to thank the students, teachers, and principals for their hard work and dedication in making this project a success.

Special gratitude goes to the parents, grandparents, guardians, and friends who contributed their

time, stories, and family recipes. Your involvement has brought these manuscripts to life, inspiring the next generation of folklorists and historians in Carrigtwohill.

About the Project

The Carrigtwohill Schools Folklore Project aims to foster a love for and a deeper understanding of Ireland's cultural heritage among local students. This collection highlights the power of community and the enduring significance of folklore, both old and new.

A special thanks goes to The Carrigtwohill Historical Society for their tireless dedication to preserving and sharing the rich history of our village. Their invaluable contribution to the Carrigtwohill Schools Folklore Project is deeply appreciated. In particular, we extend our gratitude to Tony Ó Floinn whose expertise, time, and guidance was instrumental in shaping the project. His passion and knowledge have greatly enriched this initiative. Go raibh maith agat Tony.

Contact: Angela Byrne

Email: carrigtwohillschoolsfolklore@outlook.com.

Proposal to Preserve St David's Abbey Site

On onsite meeting was held in August 2023 with Southgate Associates to discuss proposals to preserve the remaining Abbey ruins to prevent them from falling into a further ruinous state. It was Chris Southgate belief that the structure was likely from the 13th century. A mortar sample of the tower was taken for analysis.

Southgate Associates then prepared a Project Management Plan which included a ground penetrating radar survey to be undertaken to determine the extent of the Abbey as part of an application for funding which ultimately failed.

This was followed by a similar onsite meeting with members of the County Council Heritage Department in June this year, who recommended we initially concentrate on making remedial repairs to the tower where the stonework had been dislodged, and explore possible repairs to the belfry to prevent the bell from cascading down the tower causing irreparable damage. For this a conservation survey would be

required which must include an ecological element, for which emergency funding could be available.

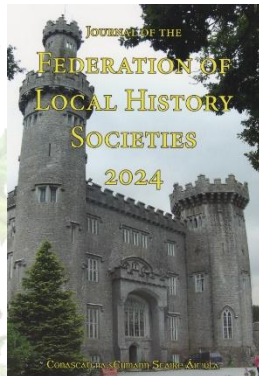
A full report of the historical society's 'Proposal to Preserve St David's Abbey Site' voted on at an earlier committee meeting was produced. It was approved and was subsequently included within the C2H2040 consultation document which may be downloaded from the Community Council's [website](#).

Our most recent substantial debate on how best to move forward with this project centred on seeking to identify potential volunteers to form a sub-committee that might for the project under the guidance of the main committee to implementing the committee approved plan to preserve the site. To this end a request was circulated seeking volunteers to which little response has been received. If anyone would consider volunteering to serve on this committee, please drop us a note outlining your interests

Journals & Publications

Federation of Local Historical Societies

"The year 2025 will mark the 840th anniversary of the arrival of Philip de Barri of Manorbier, Pembrokeshire, Wales, into Ireland, with the subsequent creation of 'Barry's Court' (now Barryscourt), Carrigtwohill, the ancestral home of David, his grandson, established at a date unknown sometime between 1185 and 1206. Barryscourt was strategically located between two Medieval ports of Cork on the mouth of the River Lee, and Youghal," is the opening paragraph of this year's Federation annual journal by André Saubolle.



The journal is full of many interesting Cork based articles including one about the 'Hidden Gems & Forgotten People' exhibition held at Bishopstown library at which was Marie McCarthy who represented the Federation, and who is a longstanding member of our society. Also present at the exhibition was André Saubolle on behalf of our society. The story of this exhibition was featured in our May issue.

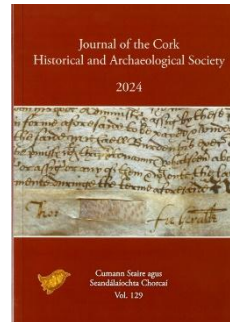
There is also an article from our friends at the Maritime History Museum, at Passage West. Another is by Gerry White of the Western Front Association where Marie is an active participant; and yet another by the Cloyne Literary and Historical Society. A few of their members are members of our society. Also featured in an article about a mariner of Kinsale, and one about the Jewish community of Cork City.

Copies of the journal may be obtained by contacting the Federation directly.

Website: <https://localhistory.ie/>.

Journal of the Cork Historical & Archaeological Society

Dáibhi de Barra manuscript



An article written by our vice-secretary, Tony Ó Floinn, was published in this year's journal. Tony explains that, "it had been a goal since 2019 to put a comprehensive account of the de Barra manuscript on the public record & this has now been done.

His opening passage for this excellent 21 page article reads:

"A few years ago a short Dáibhi de Barra manuscript in English was returned from the United States to Carrigtwohill by Paul Doherty, a descendant of an emigrant from the area whose family had preserved the manuscript carefully for a century and a half. This manuscript consisted primarily of an 1825 poem describing the services of a schoolmaster in the Middleton area. This article discusses the manuscript, its scribe, contents, travels and return, and gives a brief account of those who preserved it over multiple generations. The poem itself gives an insight into one aspect of local discourse surrounding popular education in the early nineteenth prior to the introduction of the national school system – a full transcription is provided."

PSMG 150th Anniversary of Arrival to Carrigtwohill

At last year's City Hall exhibition, Paul Shaw, Archivist, was approached by Andrew McCarthy of the journal, and was invited to write an article for next year's annual. After multiple negotiation since that day it has been agreed that Paul and André Saubolle are to co-author an article to be published next year to commemorate the Sisters' arrival to Carrigtwohill, with a 10K wordcount.

May we conclude by wishing all our members, their
families and friends
a Merry & Peaceful Christmas
&
a Happy New Year

Chair: Jim Barry

Treasurer: Michael Cummins

Vice Chair: Marie McCarthy

Members: Sister Mary Kenefick (SMG), Frank Hannigan, Ollie Sheehan, and William Ahern

Secretary: André Saubolle

Vice Secretary: Tony Ó Floinn